THE OSAKA LOOP LINE (OSAKA KANJOSEN) IS A HEAVY RAIL LINE OPERATED BY JR WEST WHICH LOOPS AROUND OSAKA, THE THIRD LARGEST CITY AND "FOOD CAPITAL" OF JAPAN. THE FIRST TRACKS IN THE LINE WERE LAID IN 1895 - MORE THAN 2500 YEARS AFTER JAPAN WAS FOUNDED IN 660 BC! THE LINE RUNS BOTH CLOCKWISE (ON THE OUTER TRACK), AS WELL AS COUNTER-CLOCKWISE (ON THE INNER TRACK). THE LOOP TAKES ABOUT 40 MINUTES TO COMPLETE A ROUNDTRIP.

OSAKA LOOP LINE

19 STATIONS
21.7 KM

JAPAN

2.69 MILLION

PRAYER GUIDE

KYOBASHI STATION

1. Pray that the people of Osaka would be able to taste and see that God is good and that He alone can fulfill their every need.

2. Pray that God would open the eyes of those involved in sexual exploitation and prostitution in Kyobashi.

3. Ask God to show the Japanese the light of the gospel of the glory of Christ so that they may turn to Jesus.

"IN THEIR CASE THE GOD OF THIS WORLD HAS BLINDED THE MINDS OF THE UNBELIEVERS, TO KEEP THEM FROM SEEING THE LIGHT OF THE GOSPEL OF THE GLORY OF CHRIST, WHO IS THE IMAGE OF GOD." 2 CORIN. 4:4

Kyobashi houses one of the city's largest business districts and is close to many tourist attractions. This district is famous for its shopping and nightlife. (due to the presence of many bars, the prostitution and exploitation is heavy in this area.)

"OH, TASTE AND SEE THAT THE LORD IS GOOD! BLESSED IS THE MAN WHO TAKES REFUGE IN HIM!" PSALM 34:8

Song: "Old McDonald"

SAKURA NOMIYA

1. Ask God to use the beauty in nature to reveal Himself to those in Japan.

2. Pray that God's love would be shown to the homeless, elderly and poor who live near this area.

3. Pray that Sakuranomiya park could be used in outreach and ministry to reach many Japanese with the Gospel.

"SO THAT THEY MAY TURN FROM DARKNESS TO LIGHT AND FROM THE POWER OF SATAN TO GOD, THAT THEY MAY RECEIVE FORGIVENESS OF SINS AND A PLACE AMONG THOSE WHO ARE SANCTIFIED BY FAITH IN ME." ACTS 26:18

Sakuranomiya literally translates as "Sakura (cherry blossom) Palace" The park near the station boast beautiful cherry blossom trees and is a popular spot for picnickers, runners, and those who enjoy nature.

"'AND THE SERVANT SAID, 'SIR, WHAT YOU COMMANDED HAS BEEN DONE, AND STILL THERE IS ROOM.' AND THE MASTER SAID TO THE SERVANT, 'GO OUT TO THE HIGHWAYS AND HEDGES AND COMPEL PEOPLE TO COME IN, THAT MY HOUSE MAY BE FILLED. LUKE 14:22-23

Song: "Sakura"

TENMA

1. Pray the Japanese would see that materialism and wealth cannot fill the God-shaped void in their lives.

2. There are many vacant buildings throughout the shopping street. Ask that God would prepare a place for a church plant.

3. Pray that the festival near Tenma would be used as an opportunity to share Christ rather than idolatrous worship.

The Tenma area is home to the longest shopping street in Japan, over 1.5 miles. This area began to flourish due to the nearby Shinto shrine where people came to worship the god of studies. A festival is held each July with fireworks and parades along the street and river.

"REMEMBER THAT YOU WERE AT THAT TIME SEPARATED FROM CHRIST, ...HAVING NO HOPE AND WITHOUT GOD IN THE WORLD. BUT NOW IN CHRIST JESUS YOU WHO ONCE WERE FAR OFF HAVE BEEN BROUGHT NEAR BY THE BLOOD OF CHRIST." EPHESIANS 2:12-13

Song: "Fireworks"

OSAKA

1. Pray for more missionaries, national pastors and Christians to surrender and be obedient to the call of reaching the Japanese.

2. Pray that God would give those workers the same compassion and love as Christ.

3. Ask that God would bring a great harvest to Japan.

"THEN HE SAID, "THE HARVEST IS PLENTIFUL, BUT THE LABORERS ARE FEW; THEREFORE PRAY EARNESTLY TO THE LORD OF THE HARVEST TO SEND OUT LABORERS INTO HIS HARVEST." MATT. 9:37-38

Osaka Station is largest station in the city, housing a total of 5 train lines not to mention the subway lines. Over 500,000 people pass through the station each day.

"WHEN HE SAW THE CROWDS, HE HAD COMPASSION ON THEM, BECAUSE THEY WERE HARASSED AND HELPLESS, LIKE SHEEP WITHOUT A SHEPHERD." MATT. 9:36

Song: "I Really Like it Here"

FUKU SHIMA

1. Pray for the Japanese who have experienced tragedy and disaster, that they would find hope in Christ.

2. Pray that God would cultivate a culture in Japan defined by His grace and love rather expectations of perfection.

3. Ask that the Holy Spirit would give the Japanese Christians a bold spirit full of hope and peace.

"GOD IS OUR REFUGE AND STRENGTH, AN EVER-PRESENT HELP IN TROUBLE. THEREFORE WE WILL NOT FEAR, THOUGH THE EARTH GIVE WAY AND THE MOUNTAINS FALL INTO THE HEART OF THE SEA, THOUGH ITS WATERS ROAR AND FOAM AND THE MOUNTAINS QUAKE WITH THEIR SURGING." PSALM 46:1-3

Outside of Japan, the name Fukushima brings to mind natural and nuclear disasters. Unfortunately, Japan is prone to natural disasters, but for the Japanese, Fukushima is also a familiar family and company name.

"PEACE I LEAVE WITH YOU; MY PEACE I GIVE TO YOU. NOT AS THE WORLD GIVES DO I GIVE TO YOU. LET NOT YOUR HEARTS BE TROUBLED, NEITHER LET THEM BE AFRAID." JOHN 14:27

Song: "Dream Flower"

NODA

1. Pray for more businesses to be flexible concerning their employees so that they can attend church.

2. Just as Jesus used fish and food to reach many, ask that He would use the area of Noda and God's creation to reach many for His Kingdom.

3. Nearby "Hell Valley" is known for its bars and night spots. Pray that Japan would turn to Jesus rather than alcohol.

The majority of Osaka's food supply comes through Osaka's Central Wholesale Market. In fact each morning at 4:15 am the market holds a special auction for the freshest tuna. Unlike most retail businesses, Osaka's Central market is closed on Sundays.

"FOR WHOEVER WOULD SAVE HIS LIFE WILL LOSE IT, BUT WHOEVER LOSES HIS LIFE FOR MY SAKE AND THE GOSPEL'S WILL SAVE IT. FOR WHAT DOES IT PROFIT A MAN TO GAIN THE WHOLE WORLD AND FORFEIT HIS SOUL?"
MARK 8:35-36

Song: "Russian Folk Song"

NISHI-KUJO

1. Intercede for the Japanese as they use amusement and other sources of "fun" to numb the pain in their lives.

2. Pray for the Gospel to work among the train drivers, mechanics, security and crews. Pray for their safety.

3. Ask that God would rescue His creations, fearfully and wonderfully made, who are contemplating suicide, specifically involving Japan's railways.

Nishi-Kujo is the nearest station to the Japan Rail West training facility, employing over 47,000 Japanese as well as the popular theme park, Universal Studios Japan.

"I PRAISE YOU, FOR I AM FEARFULLY AND WONDERFULLY MADE. WONDERFUL ARE YOUR WORKS; MY SOUL KNOWS IT VERY WELL. MY FRAME WAS NOT HIDDEN FROM YOU, WHEN I WAS BEING MADE IN SECRET, WOVEN IN THE DEPTHS OF THE EARTH." PSALM 139:14-15

Song: "American Patrol"

BEN TENCHO

"I AM THE LIVING BREAD THAT CAME DOWN FROM HEAVEN. IF ANYONE **EATS OF THIS** BREAD, HE WILL LIVE FOREVER." JOHN 6:51

1. Pray that as missionaries daily travel God would connect them to individuals who will help them to be included in culture.

2. Pray that Christians would encounter "persons of peace" who are open to talk about the Gospel.

3. Ask that pastors in Japan would work with missionaries in sound discipleship and evangelism.

Bentencho the smallest of the stations along the loop line and the closest to Osaka Bay. This small area seemingly has only one purpose, to connect the Osaka Loop Line to the Chuo Subway Line.

"SELL YOUR POSSESSIONS, AND GIVE TO THE NEEDY... WITH A TREASURE IN THE HEAVENS THAT DOES NOT FAIL, WHERE NO THIEF APPROACHES AND NO MOTH DESTROYS"

LUKE 12:33

SONG:"I've been workin' on the railroad"

TAISHO

1. Pray for the Gospel to be shared and churches to be planted among the Japanese who are from Okinawa.

2. Ask that God would bring salvation to Japan so greatly that the Osaka Dome could be filled with thousands worshipping His name.

3. Historically, Japan has been attracted to western culture. Pray that they would be taken by the idea of a relationship with God and desire abundant life in Him.

"THE THIEF COMES ONLY TO STEAL AND KILL AND DESTROY. I CAME THAT THEY MAY HAVE LIFE AND HAVE IT ABUNDANTLY."
JOHN 10:10

The Taisho area is named after the former Taisho Emperor and era in which Japan became a democratic society. This area is also home to many people from Okinawa. The Osaka Dome home to Orix Buffalo baseball is also located here.

"NOW TO HIM WHO IS ABLE TO DO FAR MORE ABUNDANTLY THAN ALL THAT WE ASK OR THINK, ACCORDING TO THE POWER AT WORK WITHIN US."
EPHESIANS 3:20

Song: "Okinawa Folk Song"

ASHIHARA BASHI

"PRAISE HIM WITH SOUNDING CYMBALS; PRAISE HIM WITH LOUD CLASHING CYMBALS! LET EVERYTHING THAT HAS BREATH PRAISE THE LORD! PRAISE THE LORD!" PSALM 150:5-6

1. Pray that Japanese churches would have an evangelistic heart for their own nation and for those who come as tourists to Osaka.

2. Ask that God would break the strongholds of Buddhism and Shinto and that the festivals could be used for His purposes.

3. Pray that the sound of drums in Japan will one day be used to praise the risen Lord.

Ashiharabashi is known for its famous landmarks in nearby Namba but also for many long established drum makers. Unfortunately, rythmic music has a long tradition within Japan's pagan festivals.

" THEREFORE, WE ARE AMBASSADORS FOR CHRIST, GOD MAKING HIS APPEAL THROUGH US. WE IMPLORE YOU ON BEHALF OF CHRIST, BE RECONCILED TO GOD." 2 CORIN. 5:20

Song: "Festival"

IMAMIYA

1. Ask the one true living God to show the Japanese that they can be made clean through His son Jesus.

2. While a classed based society no longer exists in Japan, many still are trapped in the cycles of poverty & hopelessness. Pray for all Japanese to be set free by the liberty found only in Jesus.

3. Pray that Japanese people would realize the lack of power of the "gods" as they pray and visit shrines and would search something greater.

"IF WE CONFESS OUR SINS, HE IS FAITHFUL AND JUST TO FORGIVE US OUR SINS AND TO CLEANSE US FROM ALL UNRIGHTEOUSNESS." 1 JOHN 1:9

Shinto, the native religion of Japan, considers anything related to death as unclean and repugnant. Since the people of Imamiya, "leather city" were known for crafting leather goods, they also were considered lowly and unclean.

"HE HAS SENT ME TO BIND UP THE BROKENHEARTED, TO PROCLAIM LIBERTY TO THE CAPTIVES, AND THE OPENING OF THE PRISON TO THOSE WHO ARE BOUND;" ISAIAH 61:1

Song: "god of great darkness & fortune"

SHIN-IMAMIYA

"I AM THE LIVING BREAD THAT CAME DOWN FROM HEAVEN. IF ANYONE EATS OF THIS BREAD, HE WILL LIVE FOREVER." JOHN 6:51

1. Pray for the homeless, hungry and outcast of Japan to be satisifed through the living bread of Christ.

2. Pray that God would cultivate a "new world" in the culture of Japan defined by His grace and love rather than society's expectations.

3. Ask that Japanese Christians would become more willing to reach out to those on the outskirts to share the love of Christ.

This area is sadly "home" to many homeless, outcasts and victims of cultural pressures. Each year, Imamiya Ebisu Shrine hosts "Ebessan" a festival in which Osakans pray to the gods of business and prosperity.

"SELL YOUR POSSESSIONS, AND GIVE TO THE NEEDY... WITH A TREASURE IN THE HEAVENS THAT DOES NOT FAIL, WHERE NO THIEF APPROACHES AND NO MOTH DESTROYS." LUKE 12:33

Song: "New World"

TENNOJI

1. Among all of the aesthetically pleasing buildings and urban shine, pray that the seeds of the Gospel would not get choked out by the thorns of life.

2. Pray that the truth of the Bible would be something all Japanese people long to hear and learn about.

2. Ask that the churches near Tennoji would be faithful to sow the seeds of the Gospel in truth and love.

"BUT THE CARES OF THE WORLD AND THE DECEITFULNESS OF RICHES AND THE DESIRES FOR OTHER THINGS ENTER IN AND CHOKE THE WORD, AND IT PROVES UNFRUITFUL. BUT THOSE THAT WERE SOWN ON THE GOOD SOIL ARE THE ONES WHO HEAR THE WORD AND ACCEPT IT AND BEAR FRUIT." MARK 4:19-20

Tennoji is home to one of the tallest buildings in Japan. Shitennoji Temple, known for its bells, is also located nearby. The bells are rung within the temple grounds and numbered tickets are given for entry due to the crowds.

"I MAY HEAR OF YOU THAT YOU ARE STANDING FIRM IN ONE SPIRIT, WITH ONE MIND STRIVING SIDE BY SIDE FOR THE FAITH OF THE GOSPEL." PHIL 1:27

Song: "Are You to Ring that Bell"

TERA DACHO

1. Pray that the "loop" of Buddhism or Shinto would be cut, and a new "line" in Japan would rise up as bold Christians within their families and culture.

2. Pray that instead of insisting the difficulty and even impossibility of reaching their fellow Japanese that believers would trust in the God's plan and be faithfully obedient.

"SO THAT CHRIST MAY DWELL IN YOUR HEARTS THROUGH FAITH—THAT YOU, BEING ROOTED AND GROUNDED IN LOVE, MAY HAVE STRENGTH TO COMPREHEND WITH ALL THE SAINTS WHAT IS THE BREADTH AND LENGTH AND HEIGHT AND DEPTH, AND TO KNOW THE LOVE OF CHRIST THAT SURPASSES KNOWLEDGE."
EPH. 3:17-18

Teradacho is often used to avoid the larger crowds at Tennoji station. Teradacho is technically the last station on the line. However, a new line was established in order to create an entire loop on the Osaka Line.

"I AM THE VINE; YOU ARE THE BRANCHES. WHOEVER ABIDES IN ME AND I IN HIM, HE IT IS THAT BEARS MUCH FRUIT, FOR APART FROM ME YOU CAN DO NOTHING." JOHN 15:5

Song: "Life Goes On"

MOMO DANI

1. Pray for warmth and a sense of community to be found in existing Japanese churches.

2. Pray for the truth of God's Word to inspire healthy cultural changes within the old traditions of Japan.

3. Pray for Believers both Japanese and missionaries as they work to show the love of Jesus to others.

"FOR JUST AS THE BODY IS ONE AND HAS MANY MEMBERS, AND ALL THE MEMBERS OF THE BODY, THOUGH MANY, ARE ONE BODY, SO IT IS WITH CHRIST." 1 CORIN. 12:12

Momodani's neighborhood strongly retains the charming Osaka scenery of olden days. Home to coffeehouses, penny candy shops and used book stores, this neighborhood has an atmosphere of warmth and community.

"BY THIS ALL PEOPLE WILL KNOW THAT YOU ARE MY DISCIPLES, IF YOU HAVE LOVE FOR ONE ANOTHER." JOHN 13:35

Song: "Sake, Tears, Men & Women"

TSURU HASHI

1. Pray that the Gospel will be pleasant and appealing to all those who hear.

2. Pray that as Jesus is shared, the Holy Spirit would work in the hearts and minds of the Japanese to feel His peace and hope.

3. Pray for a sweet fragrance of salvation and worship from the Japanese to rise up to God rather than incense and idolatry.

"THROUGH US SPREADS THE FRAGRANCE OF THE KNOWLEDGE OF HIM EVERYWHERE. FOR WE ARE THE AROMA OF CHRIST TO GOD AMONG THOSE WHO ARE BEING SAVED AND AMONG THOSE WHO ARE PERISHING, TO ONE A FRAGRANCE FROM DEATH TO DEATH, TO THE OTHER A FRAGRANCE FROM LIFE TO LIFE."
2 CORIN. 2:14-16

Tsuruhashi is the center of Osaka's Korea Town, well-known for its many Korean restaurants and shops. The aroma of all the delicious food in Korea Town travels even through the station. This area, though not too far from Japan's largest "slum," it is a reflection of a different era.

"JESUS SAID TO THEM, "I AM THE BREAD OF LIFE; WHOEVER COMES TO ME SHALL NOT HUNGER, AND WHOEVER BELIEVES IN ME SHALL NEVER THIRST.""
JOHN 6:35

Song: "All You Can Eat Yodel"

TAMA TSUKURI

1. Pray the Japanese would see the emptiness of their idol worship and traditions and turn to the one true God.

2. Pray the children in Japan would all have early exposure to the gospel and rise up to be a strong generation of believers.

3. Pray for Japanese Christian parents to intentionally teach the glorious deeds of the Lord to their children.

"WE WILL NOT HIDE THEM FROM THEIR CHILDREN, BUT TELL TO THE COMING GENERATION THE GLORIOUS DEEDS OF THE LORD, AND HIS MIGHT, AND THE WONDERS THAT HE HAS DONE." PSALM 78:4

Tamatsukuri station is close to the famous Inari Shrine. The shrine, traced to 12BC, was dedicated to the Shinto god Inari. Inari was enshrined in the 1580s to protect Osaka Castle. The area is also known for it's preschool, Vierra Tamatsukuri, with a lower window frame so that children may watch the trains.

"THEIR IDOLS ARE SILVER AND GOLD, THE WORK OF HUMAN HANDS....THOSE WHO MAKE THEM BECOME LIKE THEM; SO DO ALL WHO TRUST IN THEM." PSALM 115:3,8

Song: "Mary had a Little Lamb"

MORIN OMIYA

1. Pray that Japanese churches would become the front runners and catalysts for explosive progress in the mission task in Japan.

2. As the Japanese search for rest and a place of relaxation in the midst of the city, pray that they would seek Jesus for their true rest and "living water".

3. As individuals board at this station pray that God would reveal Himself to them through His beautiful creation.

"FOR HIS INVISIBLE ATTRIBUTES, NAMELY, HIS ETERNAL POWER AND DIVINE NATURE, HAVE BEEN CLEARLY PERCEIVED, EVER SINCE THE CREATION OF THE WORLD, IN THE THINGS THAT HAVE BEEN MADE."
ROMANS 1:20

This station is also used to access Osaka Castle Park and was a catalyst for the renewal of other stations. Adjacent to Morinomiya Station, there are many scenic paths, water fountains and a jogging course, which attract locals as well as tourists.

"JESUS STOOD UP AND CRIED OUT, "IF ANYONE THIRSTS, LET HIM COME TO ME AND DRINK. WHOEVER BELIEVES IN ME, AS THE SCRIPTURE HAS SAID, 'OUT OF HIS HEART WILL FLOW RIVERS OF LIVING WATER.'"
JOHN 7:36-38

Song: Bear of the Forest

OSAKAJO-KOEN

1. Pray that the Japanese would surrender to Jesus and call on God as their deliver and stronghold.

2. Ask that Christianity would be a light in Japan and solid doctrine would persevere in the midst of capitalism.

3. Pray that believers would trust God to be their rock and shield concerning successes and in relationships as they share Christ.

"THE LORD IS MY ROCK AND MY FORTRESS AND MY DELIVERER, MY GOD, MY ROCK, IN WHOM I TAKE REFUGE, MY SHIELD, AND THE HORN OF MY SALVATION, MY STRONGHOLD." PSALM 18:2

Osaka Castle Park surrounds the famous Osaka Castle which can often be seen lit up at night. Built by Toyotomi Hideyoshi in 1583 and rebuilt by shoguns in the 1620s, the Castle is one of the few to have survived air raids during World War II.

"THE LORD IS MY LIGHT AND MY SALVATION; WHOM SHALL I FEAR? THE LORD IS THE STRONGHOLD OF MY LIFE; OF WHOM SHALL I BE AFRAID?" PSALM 27:1-3

Song: "Conch"